



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

(FILM AND THEATRE ARTS)

CFT 302: STAGE CRAFT

2ND SEMESTER 2024/2025

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS: ANSWER QUESTION ONE AND ANY OTHER TWO.

1. READ THE SCENE DESCRIPTION BELOW AND ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS.

A sacred clearing at the heart of the forest. A single tall wooden spear stands planted in the center of the stage, wrapped in red cloth. The ground is scattered with ash, suggesting the site of an old ritual fire.

Characters:

- **Kioni:** A young warrior, uncertain but determined.
- **Elder Malewa:** A stern village elder, dressed in a cloak of woven bark and beads.
- **The Spirit of the Spear:** A spectral figure, masked and draped in shimmering white fabric, representing the ancestors.

Scene:

(Kioni stands at the edge of the clearing, gripping a small dagger. Elder Malewa stands by the spear, his hands clasped behind his back.)

Elder Malewa: (gravely) Kioni, the spear awaits. Only those who are worthy may grasp it.

Kioni: (hesitant) And if I fail?

Elder Malewa: Then the ancestors will claim your spirit, and the village will fall.

(A gust of wind blows through the clearing, causing the red cloth on the spear to flutter. The Spirit of the Spear steps forward, their movements slow and deliberate.)

Spirit of the Spear: (echoing) Kioni, why do you come?

Kioni: (nervously) I come to protect my people.

Spirit of the Spear: Protection demands sacrifice. Will you give your blood for the spear?

(Kioni hesitates, then raises the dagger and cuts his palm, letting a few drops of blood fall onto the ash-covered ground. The Spirit nods approvingly.)

Spirit of the Spear: Then take it.

(Kioni steps forward, his hand trembling as he grips the spear. The stage lights dim, and a soft glow surrounds him as the Spirit fades into the shadows.)

Elder Malewa: (smiling faintly) The ancestors have accepted you. You are now the guardian of our people.

(Kioni lifts the spear high, his expression changing to one of pride and resolve. The sound of distant drums fills the air as the lights fade to black.)

- a) Develop a list for setting up the stage (10 marks)
 - b) Draw the layout for the above scene (10 marks)
2. Explain the following terms as used in stage craft (10 marks)
- a) Flats (2 marks)
 - b) Platforms (2 marks)
 - c) Wagons (2 marks)
 - d) Stairs (2 marks)
 - e) Drops (2 marks)
3. Lighting is a crucial component in stage craft and stage design. Discuss. (10 marks)
4. Explain 5 principles of design and how they relate to stage craft (10 marks)
5. Describe the function of sound design in a theatrical production (10 marks)